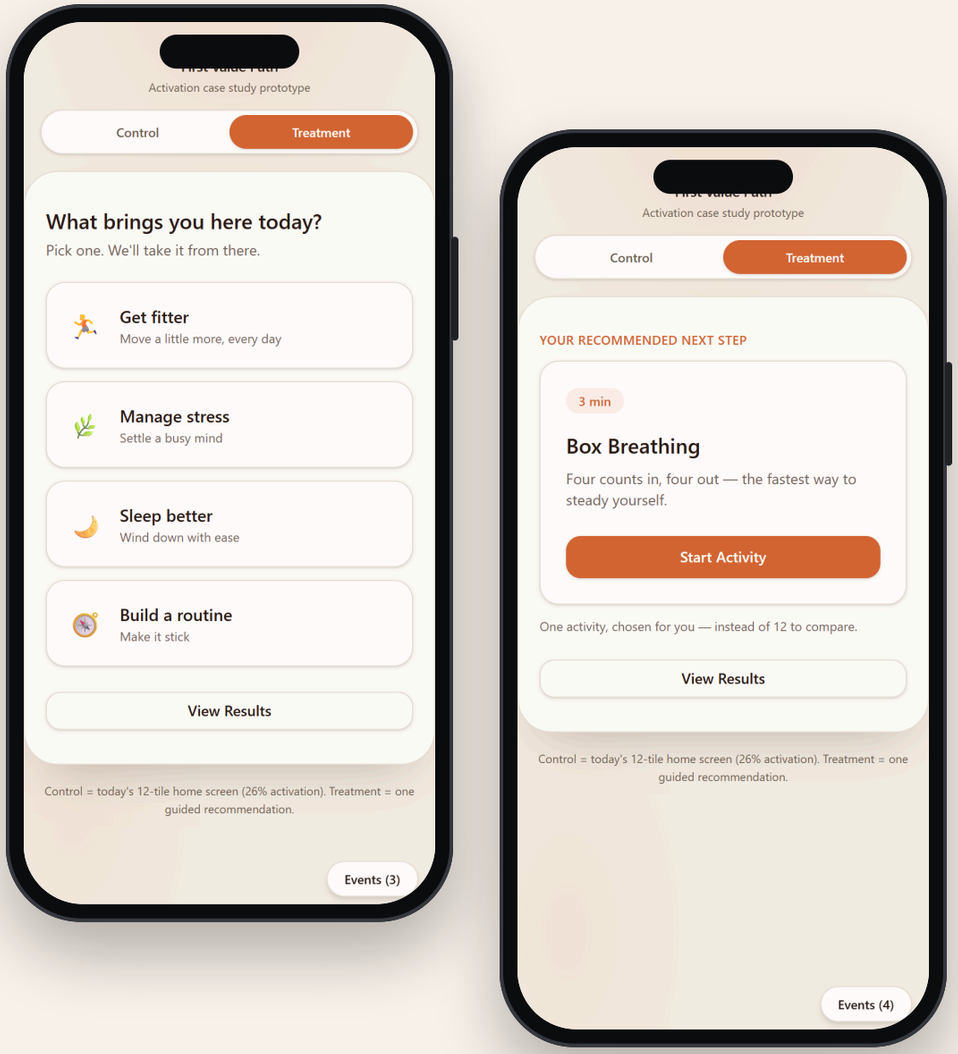
Case Study: Tulu

Product: Tulu Health App

Goal: Reframe a growth ask from acquisition to activation, and ship a working fix

Read: 5 minutes

Author: Godhuli Vyas



The problem is the first five minutes

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Installs were up 23% and the team wanted more acquisition. The data said something else: the share of users making it from install to first activity had fallen from 42% to 26%, a 37% relative decline. **Instead of a slide about the fix, I built a working prototype of it.**

Associate PM case | Activation, not acquisition | Lovable prototype | Control / Treatment toggle

Key Insights:

Installs went up. Everything after install went down. Signup and first-activity completion fell, then retention and NPS.

Biggest catch: a 2.4x retention relationship that was not real yet, because of duplicated Android events.

Shipped as a clickable prototype with an instrumentation layer, so the experiment can be demoed.

What the data says

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+23%

Installs

Volume up, quality unverified

26%

Install to first activity, down from 42%

The largest relative drop in the funnel

37%

Relative decline

The single biggest lever in the dataset

Retention declines downstream of activation: consistent with, but not yet proof of, activation being the upstream driver.

Three hypotheses, ranked by confidence

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Hypothesis	Confidence	Reasoning
Onboarding friction is suppressing activation	High	Signup and first-activity completion fell together, which points to a structural funnel problem, not noise.
Acquisition mix shifted to lower-retention segments	Medium	Fitness is the largest source and has the weakest retention, so blended metrics can worsen with an unchanged product.
Technical or performance friction compounds the loss	Needs validation	Not evidenced yet, but cheap to check.

Data integrity: caught early

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1

The trap

Android duplicates activity events in an estimated 8 to 12% of sessions, so the reported 2.4x retention relationship may be inflated.

2

The order of checks

- De-duplicate activity events
- Recalculate on clean data
- Segment by channel, platform, cohort
- Only then run a controlled test

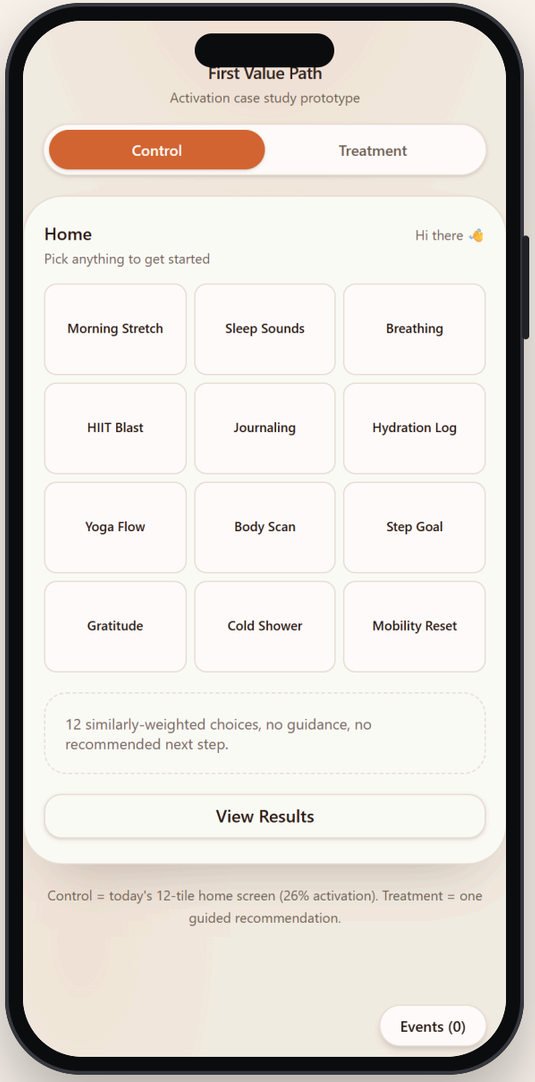
3

Same discipline

The headline "paid conversion 4.8% to 5.1%" depends on a denominator the brief never states. It is confirmed before it is reported as a win.

The prototype: Control

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Control is **today's home screen:** 12 similarly weighted tiles.

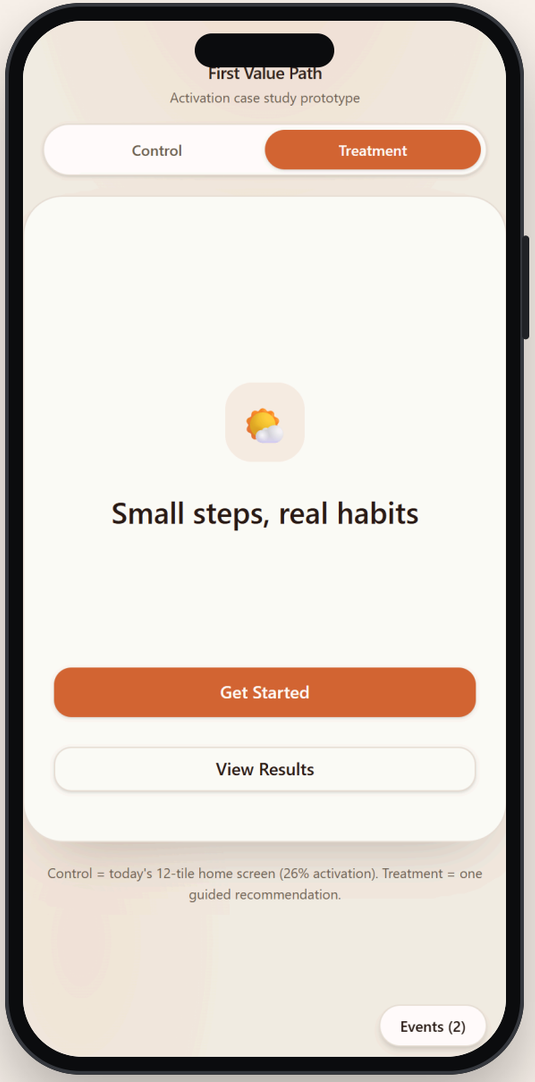
The prototype says it plainly: **no guidance, no recommended next step.**

A **Control / Treatment toggle** on top lets anyone flip between the two experiences.

Solution: Treatment: one guided path instead of 12 choices.

The prototype: Treatment 1-2

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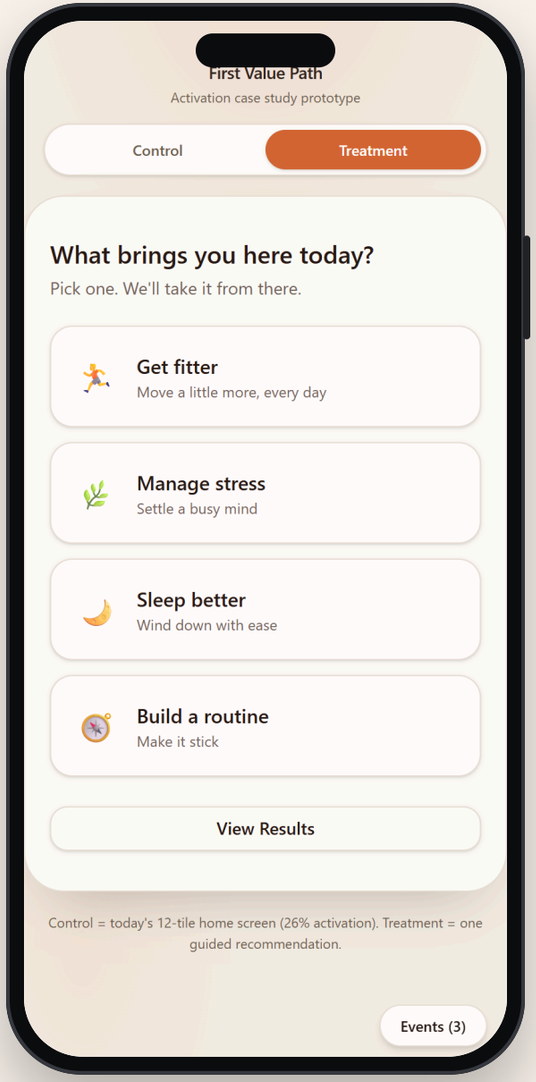


1. Welcome

Welcome sets the expectation in one line with a single CTA. No feature list.

Goal selection uses cards, not a form: get fitter, manage stress, sleep better, build a routine.

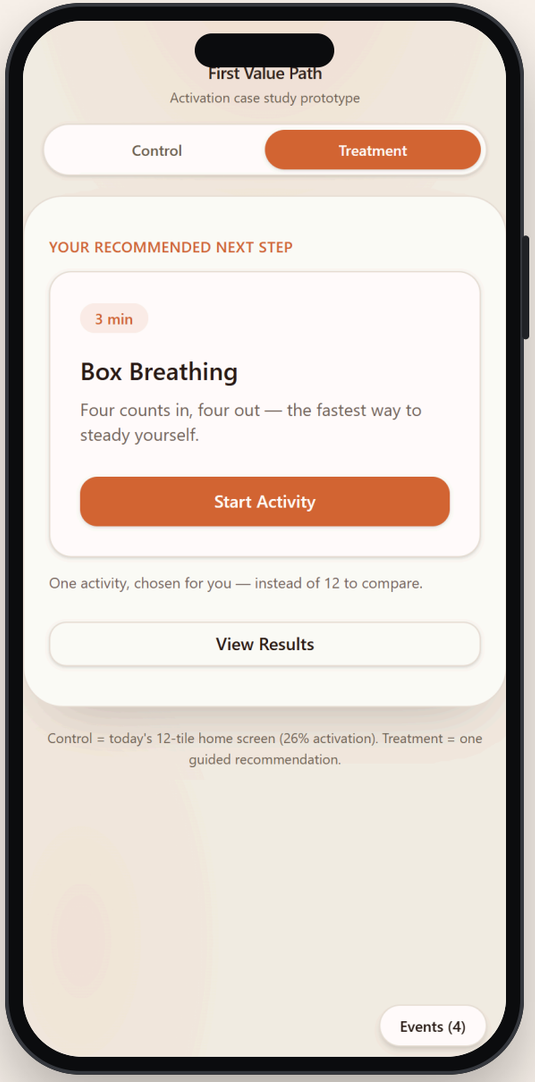
Cards cut choice friction at the highest-risk step.



2. Goal selection

The prototype: Treatment 3-4

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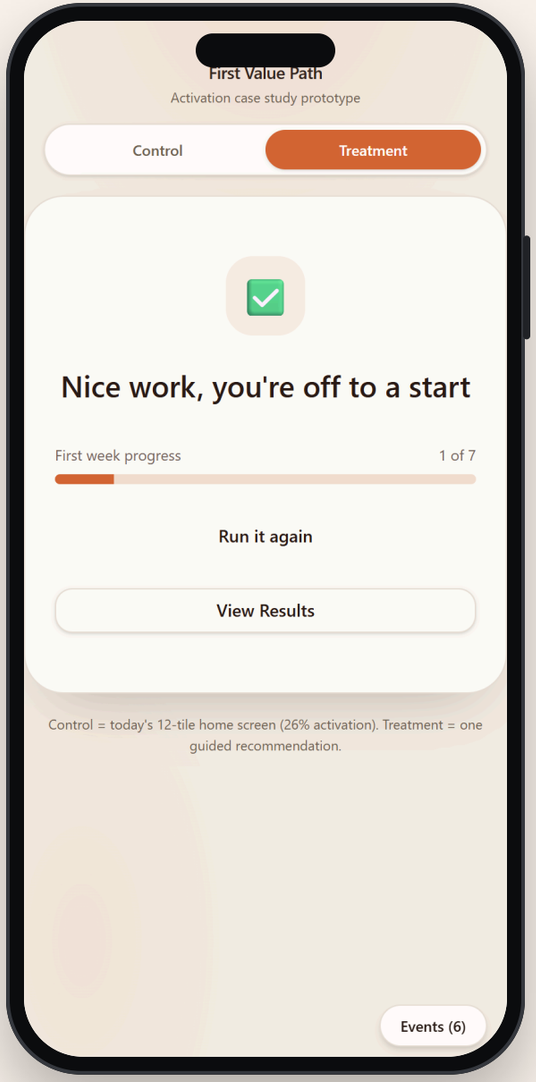
3. Recommended activity

One matched activity, not a catalog. This removes the choice overload from hypothesis one.

Completion says "Nice work, you're off to a start" with a progress signal.

It confirms value was delivered, not just that a screen was completed.

Solution: Step 5 is one lightweight next action, not a full plan.



4. Completion

Metrics and the fake-win trap

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NORTH STAR METRIC

Weekly Engaged Users: unique users completing a meaningful core activity on 2+ days in a rolling 7-day period

Definition to be validated against the app's core value before it is finalised.

PRIMARY: ACTIVATION RATE

Share of new users completing the first meaningful activity, using the existing first-activity event as the starting definition.

GUARDRAILS

Opt-out, uninstall and crash rate. "Activation up, D30 down" is a fake win and is flagged automatically.

Prioritisation: 12 engineer-weeks

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Priority	Item	Why
P0	Onboarding simplification	Addresses the largest funnel loss, install to first activity, at low risk.
P1	Performance fixes	Sequenced after onboarding data confirms the real friction point.
P2	Notification experiment	A re-engagement lever, but only after understanding why users disengage.
Defer	Personalised home, weekly plan, AI coach	Not a rejection. The data shows an activation problem, not an intelligence problem.

Post-launch: partial win

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+

Positive

- Behaviour +18%
- D7 retention +6%
- Paid conversion +2%

=

Unresolved

- D30 retention unchanged

-

Negative

- NPS -3
- Opt-outs +14%

Thank you for reading.

Live prototype: tulu-health.lovable.app

Walkthrough: Loom video

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DISCLAIMER

A case study on Tulu Health built from a case brief. The screens are real captures of my own working prototype. Metrics and prioritisation are proposals, not measured results from Tulu.

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